

STEPHANIE LYONS

Customer & Operations Leader | CX & SaaS Executive | AI Enabled Operations Leader

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\$68M→\$122M Combined Revenue Growth (tenure)	105% Customer Retention	153% NRR Increase	99.4% Peak CSAT	28 Days Onboarding (was 4–6 mo)	–52% Support Handle Time	\$3.7M Portfolio, NearZero Churn
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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Customer Operations executive with 15+ years building and scaling high efficiency postsale operations at high growth SaaS companies. A hands-on builder of AI-enabled systems: I shipped internal tooling with AI coding assistants when engineering capacity was limited, built self-updating knowledge bases from live data, rearchitected customer support operations with AI-assisted routing and triage (52% handle time reduction), and developed predictive models to surface revenue opportunities. Led globally distributed teams across five countries and three continents. Track record: architecting scalable customer operations, building teams that own outcomes, and driving measurable impact—\$68M→\$122M combined revenue growth across four organizations.

CAREER HISTORY

Vice President of Customer Experience 2024 – 2025

Opus1.io — SaaS platform for music school management

- **AI-built onboarding:** used vibe coding and AI coding assistants to build custom internal workflows when Engineering lacked capacity — then documented the code and process specs and handed them to the CTO for productization — compressing onboarding from 4–6 months to 28 days.
- **AI knowledge base:** trained a self-updating knowledge base on real support chat transcripts, removing the manual documentation burden from the team.
- **AI support automation:** rearchitected Zendesk with AI-assisted routing, response suggestions, and triage logic, cutting average handle time by 52% reduction while CSAT rose from 86% to 99.4%.
- **Predictive upsell:** fed usage report data into AI models to surface expansion signals before clients identified their own needs, shifting the team from reactive to predictive.
- Led a globally distributed team of 12 across the US, Philippines, Argentina, and Mexico (Customer Success, Onboarding, and Support); rebuilt the postsale function end-to-end and reached 105% customer retention within six months. Company revenue grew \$8M to \$12M.

Sr. Director of Onboarding and Customer Success 2022 – 2023

Upside — US cashback rewards platform (restaurants, gas, retail)

- **AI-assisted analysis:** surfaced recurring integration failure patterns, enabling proactive fixes rather than repeated reactive resolution and cutting onboarding cycle time 25%.
- Led 6 direct reports across the US and India; built a merchant onboarding and education framework from scratch with clear ownership between Success and Implementation, driving a 30% increase in merchant retention and a 25% improvement in CSAT.
- Reduced technical integration issues 50% and increased successful integrations 40%; reduced escalations 25% and improved crossfunctional efficiency 30%. Company revenue grew \$30M to \$50M.

Vice President of Customer Success 2021 – 2022

Marketing Evolution — marketing attribution platform (consulting to SaaS)

- Led a team of 10 across the US and Ukraine; secured \$1.2M in upsells through platform utilisation analysis and proactive account management, without additional headcount.
- Implemented Looker, Salesforce, and Gainsight dashboards for real time client health visibility
- Built a SaaS-scale onboarding framework supporting the company's full consulting to SaaS transformation. Company revenue grew \$25M to \$40M.

Director of Client Services 2016 – 2021

Pathmatics — digital marketing intelligence and ad analytics

- Delivered a 153% Net Revenue Retention (NRR) increase over three years, directly contributing to the company's acquisition. Company revenue grew \$5M to \$20M.
- Managed a \$3.7M book of 38 top tier accounts (P&G, Google, Turbo Tax, BOA, Target, Hershey, Verizon Media, LinkedIn, Snapchat) supporting 5,000+ users — three years, no churn.
- Led a team of 5; identified a critical platform flaw stalling adoption, and the findings led directly to the creation of two new products.
- Implemented Zendesk and introduced QBRs and customer councils to rebuild crossfunctional feedback loops with Product and Sales.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Product Manager, Media Partnerships — Monster Worldwide (2011–2016)**
Led ad operations and partnerships; \$2M incremental revenue; Monster CEO Award (2012 & 2014).
- **SEM & Social Media Supervisor — Yahoo! Hot Jobs (2010–2011)**
Led a 10person ad ops team; +55% campaign ROI; Employee of the Year (2010).

AI & TECHNOLOGY LEADERSHIP

Practitioner level AI integration across the customer lifecycle — not just a user, but a builder:

- **Vibe Coding & Internal Tooling:** shipped functional internal tools with AI coding assistants when Engineering lacked bandwidth, then handed off to the CTO for productization.
- **AI Knowledge Base:** trained a self updating knowledge base on live support conversations, cutting manual documentation.
- **Support Automation:** rebuilt Zendesk with AI assisted routing and triage; cut handle time 52% without sacrificing CSAT.
- **Predictive Revenue Modelling:** applied AI to usage data to surface upsell signals before clients self identified, reactive to predictive.
- **ProcessFirst Mindset:** codified every AI initiative into playbooks so nontechnical teams run AI enhanced operations independently.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Customer Success & CX: CS Strategy; Onboarding; Churn & Retention; CSAT / NPS / NRR; HighTouch & SelfServe

Leadership & Operations: Globally Distributed Teams (5 countries); Managing Managers; Change & Transformation

Technology & AI: AI Automation & Vibe Coding; Salesforce; HubSpot; Gainsight; Looker; Zendesk; JIRA; Zapier

AWARDS, RECOGNITION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Employee of the Year — Yahoo! Hot Jobs (2010) — revenue growth and continuity through acquisition.
- Monster CEO Award — Monster Worldwide (2012 & 2014) — revenue growth and operational excellence.
- Data Leader — Pathmatics (2020) — product enhancements driven by Salesforce data analysis.
- Team Player — Pathmatics (2018) — crossteam process design and execution.